

Ginkgo

Ginkgo biloba



Origin

Native to a small region of southeastern China; wild ginkgo populations are so rare that the species survived mainly because it was cultivated in temple gardens for over 1,000 years.

Look for

Ginkgo has no close living relatives at all -- it's the last surviving member of an entire ancient plant lineage that otherwise died out over 200 million years ago.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: unmistakable fan shape with parallel veins, unlike any other street tree.
- Fall color: turns gold almost all at once, often dropping within a day or two.
- Twigs: short, knobby "spur" twigs along bare winter branches.
- Commonly confused with: nothing else -- ginkgo's leaf shape is unique among all street trees.

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Fan-shaped leaves unfurl bright green.
Summer	Leathery green leaves resist insects and disease almost completely.
Fall	Leaves turn a uniform brilliant gold and can drop within a single day or two.
Winter	Distinctive short, knobby spur twigs stand out on bare branches.

DID YOU KNOW

- Female ginkgo trees produce seeds with a pulp that smells strongly unpleasant when stepped on -- nearly all city street ginkgos are male trees to avoid this.
- Ginkgos are famously tough: several trees within a mile of the 1945 Hiroshima bombing survived and are still alive today.